supposed to meet on Eid.

God! I was so embarrassed! I had said a lot of personal things to her – him – or whatever. I was also furious because I had been duped in matters of the heart! So I finally gathered the wits to ask him why he had pretended to be a woman and he said that he'd heard that I only talk to girls on the phone and not men! I was so embarrassed! I didn't know whether to give him a whipping or invite him in for a cup of tea.

I did the latter and made small talk, not being able to maintain eye contact with this young lad. Eventually, I warmed up to him as I came up with another bright idea: I would deploy him for the same trick he had played on me – with my friends.

So I started using him to play pranks on my pals. He duped quite a few of them, just like he had duped me. God, he had a gorgeous voice. Very versatile! He could even sing in the voice of a woman. He would invite my pals over for a date and stand them up. He had quite a wicked sense of humour. Will you believe it, he even convinced a pal of mine – a famous bowler I won't name – over the phone to marry him?

I like gigs outside of cricket. I like doing ads. It's fun working with the camera. But the Pakistani ad-makers have a very different approach compared to international ad filmmakers: they have no respect for time and even the smallest job takes days. The *goras*, on the other hand, are more punctual.

But I've liked working in front of the camera. In the beginning, it was tough. You eventually get used to it. The lone shoots aren't fun. It's good to have some company, some partners around. I remember doing this soft drink ad with the boys, back in the day. Wasim Akram, Javed Miandad and the gang were in it. The problem was, Javed had to say a line, and he couldn't deliver it properly because of his lisp. We were there for two hours, all for Javed's one-liner, which was: '*Humain jazbay ke saath khelna hai*'. Only problem was, he kept on saying, '*Humain zuzbay ke saath khelna hai*'. It was hilarious. Poor guy.

As for celebrity crushes, I wish I had one. I believe most celebrities are made up. Too much make-up, literally, if you know what I mean. If you want to be a serious cricketer, you have to leave your weaknesses behind. You've got to be a serious professional. And, these days, you've got to do yourself a favour and stay away from social media as much as possible. Some of my recent tweets have received more attention than was required. I'm learning from this experience.

I've advised the young guns in the team – especially the ones who start feeling the love and hype of social media after a good performance – to keep some distance from it. It's destructive. It builds you up, makes you a star and then rips you apart. One bad performance and all the insults and trolling which come your way shatter your nerves and confidence. You can't take the pressure. In effect, you become a victim of your own social media machine. It's bad for business.

Eventually, when you've developed a thick skin, you should be able to do your own thing. But the replacement of old-school partying and socializing with the tempting, addictive world of social media gimmickry is ridiculous. It's made lesser men of sportsmen. It's got to go.